

Riyadh Mobility Intelligence Starter Kit

Build and Deployment Workbook

A polished, local-first build path for teams adapting mobility intelligence, district scoring, and Azure-backed urban development prototypes.

Document targets

Run locally Sample data, map fallback, district selector, score panel local	Explain the system FastAPI, JavaScript, data fallback, Azure services system
Deploy credibly Container Apps, Maps, Blob, Cosmos, App Insights cloud	Adapt by track Technology, People, Sustainability, Culture reuse

RIYADH URBAN INTELLIGENCE LAB — 2026

Mobility Intelligence

لوحة التنقل الذكي

6 real metro lines & 100+ bus routes from RCRC open data. Select any Riyadh district to compute a transit accessibility score — stored in Azure Cosmos DB, served by Azure Container Apps.

6

METRO LINES

100

BUS ROUTES

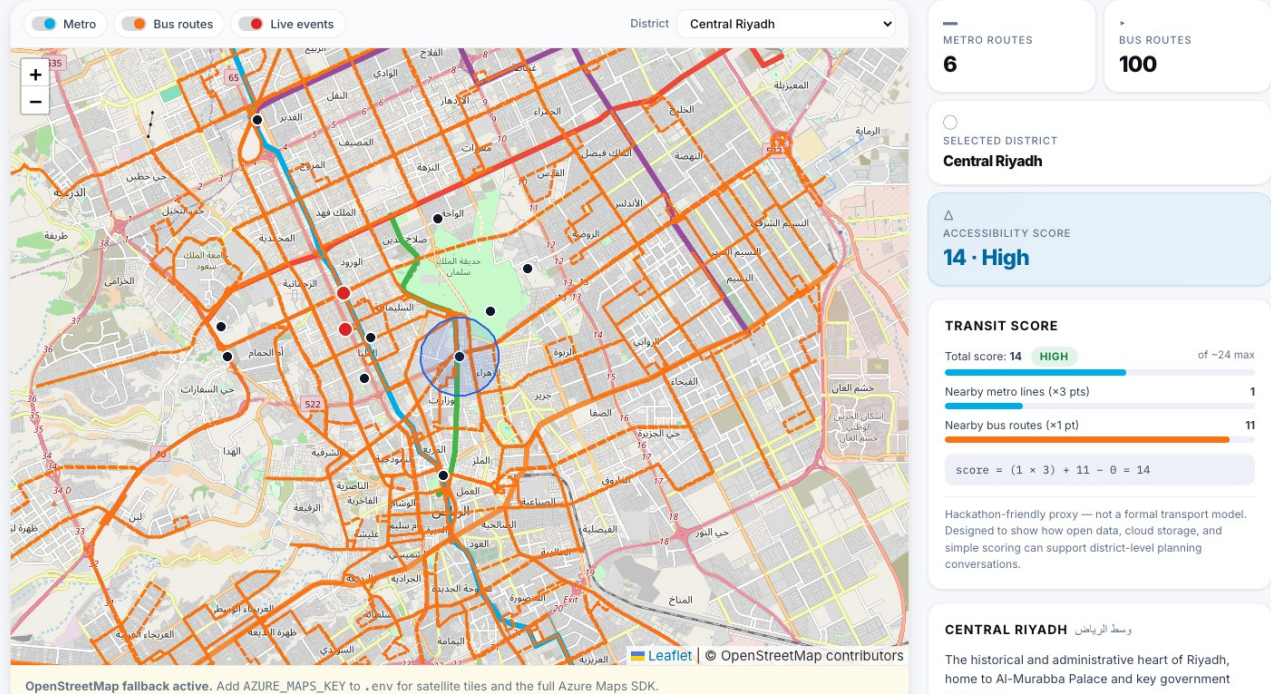
10

DISTRICTS

RCRC

OPEN DATA

METRO LINES (REAL RCRC DATA): Blue — SAB Bank ↔ Ad Dar Al Baida Red — KSU ↔ King Fahad Sport City Orange — Jeddah Rd ↔ Khashm Al An Yellow — Airport ↔ KAFD Green — Ministry of Ed ↔ Nat'l Museum Purple —



Transformational Technology | Prosperous People | Azure-backed path | Sample-first fallback

Prepared for atomcamp Arabia and Microsoft collaboration

How to Use This Guide

A practical build path for teams who need to understand, run, inspect, deploy, and adapt the Riyadh Mobility Intelligence starter kit with minimal help.

Quick access	Link / location
GitHub repo	https://github.com/Esturban/microsoft-hackathon-riyadh-mobility
Local app	http://127.0.0.1:8000
Deployed app	Paste WEB_APP_URL from azd output here
Resource index	Appendix: Azure docs, deployment notes, project references

Builder playbook

01 Understand app Read what the dashboard, layers, score panel, and fallback chain are doing.	02 Run locally Create the Python environment, start FastAPI, and wait for the slow initial load.
03 Inspect API Check /health, /api/data-status, routes, districts, and score responses.	04 Select district Use Riyadh North or Al Olaya and confirm the score panel updates.
05 Deploy Azure Use az login, azd auth login, and scripts/deploy_azure.sh when ready.	06 Adapt track Keep the scaffold; replace data, scoring, layers, and Azure services by track.

Local-first principle: Get the dashboard working from bundled sample data before adding cloud credentials, Blob Storage, Cosmos DB, or a deployed app URL.

Executive Build Brief

A local-first, Azure-ready workbook for teams turning open mobility data into a credible urban intelligence prototype.

Proof points

106 route records across metro and bus sample layers sample data	10 district records available for scoring and demos districts	9 API endpoints to inspect, extend, and deploy contracts	7+ Azure services mapped to clear runtime jobs cloud
--	---	--	--

What this proves

Working dashboard A connected map, district context, explainable score, and data fallback.	Starter kit, not final model The score is deliberately simple; the value is the transparent scaffold.
--	---

Build path

Run sample mode Confirm local app, fallback, route layers, selector, and panel.	Inspect contracts Review health, data-status, routes, districts, and score.
Connect Azure Deploy hosting, maps, files, records, monitoring, and diagnostics.	Adapt for track Replace data and scoring while keeping the shell and deployment path.

Design principle: Keep the first successful path simple: sample data locally, transparent API behavior, then Azure services only when the team is ready to make the prototype cloud-live.

1. What Builders Are Actually Building

A local-first mobility intelligence scaffold: open the dashboard, inspect transport layers, select a district, and explain an access score.

Core experience

Map the network Show metro and bus layers with fallback tiles when Azure Maps is not configured. app/static/src/map.js	Select a district Anchor every demo around Riyadh district records. /api/districts	Explain the score Turn nearby metro, bus, and event inputs into a replaceable score. app/scoring.py
---	---	--

Starter-kit principle

Run without cloud Bundled sample data keeps the app useful before Azure is ready. DATA_MODE=sample	Keep contracts stable The frontend and API use the same contract locally and in Azure. FastAPI + static frontend	Swap the domain Replace data, scoring, or overlays while keeping the app shell. track adaptation
---	---	---

Judge-facing proof

Visible data layers Show transit coverage, district context, and live event markers. dashboard	Transparent logic The score formula is simple enough to explain live. /api/score	Azure-ready path The same containerized app can move to Azure when ready. azure.yaml + infra/
---	---	--

Product thesis: Prove the end-to-end build path first, then let teams make the domain model more ambitious.

2. Urban Challenge Track Mapping

Lead with Transformational Technology, then use the same district-scoring scaffold for Prosperous People and targeted extension tracks.

Primary story

Transformational Technology Use mobility layers, route visibility, fallback-aware data, APIs, and Azure deployment to prove a working urban intelligence path. primary fit	Prosperous People Convert the district score into service access, walkability, 15-minute city coverage, or quality-of-life comparison. strong secondary	Builder pitch Show a credible local app first, then explain how the same scaffold can support richer district intelligence. demo narrative
---	--	---

Extension paths

Sustainable Solutions Add AQI, heat, emissions, low-carbon route scoring, and clean-corridor recommendations after the core map works. extension	Culture Add heritage sites, event-day routing, visitor flows, multilingual notes, and crowd-sensitive access planning. extension	What to keep Keep the frontend shell, FastAPI contracts, sample fallback, score panel, and Azure deployment shape. reuse
---	---	---

Azure emphasis

Maps Azure Maps supports the cloud map path once keys are configured. AZURE_MAPS_KEY	Data Blob Storage and Cosmos DB support processed files and app-shaped records. Blob + Cosmos	Runtime Container Apps, App Insights, and Log Analytics make the prototype deployable and observable. cloud-live
---	--	---

Positioning rule: Do not sell this as a final transport model. Sell it as a credible build path for urban intelligence prototypes.

Services and Tools Matrix

The stack reads best as a set of clear jobs: local app runtime, data and maps, Azure hosting, and diagnostics. Each tool has one reason to exist.

Local app runtime

FastAPI Backend API plus static frontend serving. app/main.py, app/routes.py	Vanilla JavaScript Dashboard boot, map controls, panels, and API calls. app/static/src/	Sample files Guaranteed fallback so teams can demo without Azure. app/static/sample-data/
---	--	--

Map and cloud data

Azure Maps Cloud map SDK and services when a key is configured. AZURE_MAPS_KEY	Blob Storage Processed GeoJSON and JSON files for cloud data mode. upload_to_blob.py	Cosmos DB Route, district, and event records for app-shaped data. seed_cosmos.py
---	---	---

Deploy and observe

Container Apps Hosted FastAPI/frontend runtime. azure.yaml, infra/main.bicep	Container Registry Container image storage for the deployed app. infra/modules/	App Insights + Logs Health, failures, latency, requests, and diagnostics. Azure portal
---	--	---

Infrastructure workflow

Bicep Infrastructure-as-code for reproducible Azure resources. infra/main.bicep	Azure Developer CLI Environment provisioning and deploy workflow. azd / deploy script	Tests API, data-shape, health, and scoring checks. tests/
--	--	--

3. Architecture and Build Path

The app is designed to work locally first, then graduate into an Azure-backed live path. The app must remain useful even when Azure credentials, remote services, or live data are unavailable.

Flow map

Local-first path Browser -> FastAPI -> static frontend/API -> bundled sample data -> score panel. no Azure required	Azure-backed path Browser -> Container Apps -> FastAPI -> Azure Maps / Blob / Cosmos / App Insights. cloud-live
Fallback chain Cosmos when configured -> Blob when configured -> bundled sample files always. resilient data	Score request flow User selects district -> frontend calls /api/score -> backend loads data -> panel renders result. explainable

Editable build-path diagrams

Browser to backend Browser opens the static dashboard served by FastAPI. Browser -> FastAPI	Backend to data FastAPI loads Cosmos, Blob, or bundled sample files through one data-access layer. API -> data
Data to interface GeoJSON, route records, events, and score components return to the dashboard. data -> UI	Fallback order Use Cosmos when configured, Blob when configured, and sample files always. Cosmos -> Blob -> sample

Builder move: Start with DATA_MODE=sample, then move to Blob or Cosmos only after the local app is working.

4. Project Structure

Start with the app shell, API, frontend, sample data, deployment files, and tests.

```
riyadh-mobility-intelligence-dashboard/  
├── app/                # FastAPI app, API, frontend, sample data  
├── scripts/            # fetch, normalize, upload, seed, validate  
├── infra/              # Bicep infrastructure modules  
├── docs/               # build guide and supporting notes  
├── tests/              # scoring, API, and data-shape checks  
├── azure.yaml          # Azure Developer CLI project  
├── Dockerfile          # container definition  
└── requirements.txt    # Python dependencies
```

Area	Start here	Why it matters
Backend endpoints	app/main.py, app/routes.py	FastAPI app shell, static serving, API contract
Data loading	app/data_access.py, app/static/sample-data/	sample, Blob, and Cosmos fallback behavior
Score formula	app/scoring.py	transparent scoring logic that teams can adapt
Frontend	app/static/index.html, app/static/src/main.js	page shell, boot sequence, API orchestration
Map behavior	app/static/src/map.js, app/static/src/layers.js	Azure Maps path, local fallback, overlays
Deployment	azure.yaml, infra/main.bicep, scripts/deploy_azure.sh	cloud-live path
Tests	tests/	API, data-shape, health, and scoring checks

Where the Data Comes From

The bundled sample data is derived from Riyadh Commission for Riyadh City open geospatial datasets. The files live under app/static/sample-data/ and keep the app useful even when no cloud services are configured.

File	Contents	Records
riyadh_metro_lines_sample.geojson	Metro line features with names, colors, and geometry	6

riyadh_bus_routes_sample.geojson	Bus route features with route IDs and geometry	100
district_centers_sample.geojson	Riyadh district center points with English and Arabic names	10
mock_live_events_sample.json	Sample delay or incident markers	variable

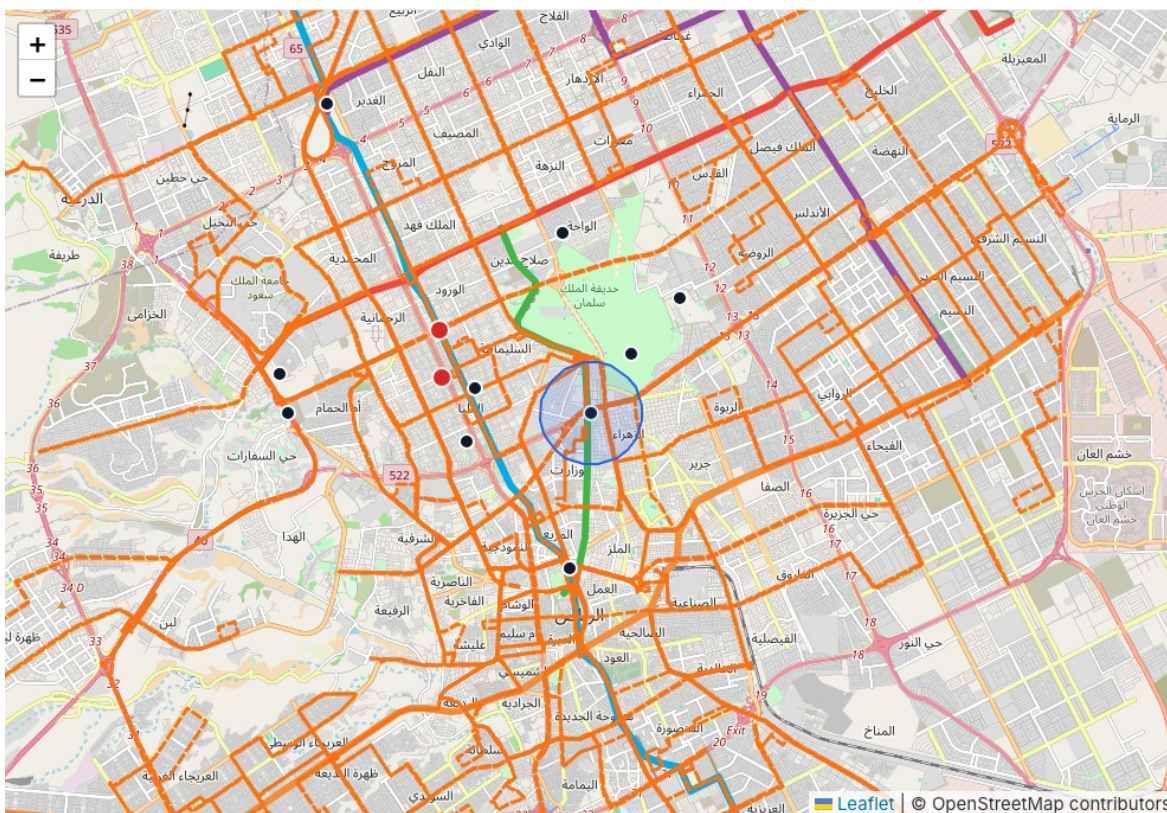
5. Run Locally

Local setup is deliberately direct. The goal is to get one useful screen running before adding cloud services.

```
git clone https://github.com/Esturban/microsoft-hackathon-riyadh-mobility.git
cd microsoft-hackathon-riyadh-mobility
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate          # Windows: .venv\Scripts\activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env
```

```
DATA_MODE=sample
python -m uvicorn app.main:app --reload
http://127.0.0.1:8000
```

Slow-load warning: The first page load can take time. Wait for the district selector, layer controls, map container, and score panel before judging success.



RUN CHECKS

Riyadh Mobility Intelligence Starter Kit

Local Verification Gates

UI readiness

Dashboard loads

Open `http://127.0.0.1:8000` and wait for the app shell.

local browser

Map renders

Azure Maps or OpenStreetMap
should render with route overlays.

map + fallback

Districts appear

The selector should show 10 districts and update the panel.

district selector

API checks

Health endpoint

Return a small OK response from FastAPI.

```
curl -s /health
```

Data status

Confirm sample mode, counts, and fallback notes.

```
curl -s /api/data-status
```

Score endpoint

Call or trigger the endpoint to confirm scoring.

/api/score?districtId=...

Builder commands

Validate data

Run this when map layers or counts look wrong.

```
python scripts/validate_data.py
```

Run tests

Catch API, health, data-shape, and scoring regressions.

```
python -m pytest
```

Stay local first

Move to cloud only after the local proof path is stable.

```
DATA_MODE=sample
```

Success signal: Dashboard visible, overlays present, selector populated, score panel updating, /health OK, and /api/data-status explaining the active data source.

6. Backend Walkthrough

The backend is a small FastAPI application. It serves both the API and the static frontend so the starter kit stays easy to run and easy to deploy.

Backend API contracts

Bootstrap /health and /api/config confirm app health and runtime settings. health/config	Map layers /api/routes and /api/routes/geojson?mode=... return counts and map-ready geometry. routes
District scoring /api/districts and /api/score?districtId=... drive the selector and score panel. score	Diagnostics /api/live-events and /api/data-status explain events, mode, and fallback behavior. status

GET /api/data-status

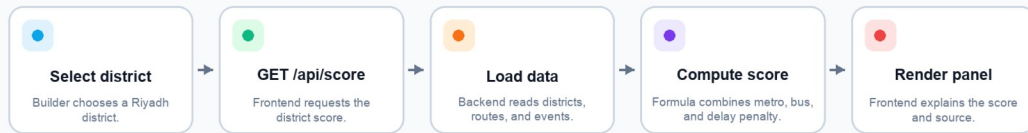
Actual local response captured from http://127.0.0.1:8000

```
{
  "requestedMode": "sample",
  "routes": {
    "count": 106,
    "source": "sample"
  },
  "districts": {
    "source": "sample"
  },
  "liveEvents": {
    "enabled": true,
    "source": "sample",
    "count": 2
  },
  "activeMode": "sample",
  "fallbackMessage": "Azure services are optional. The app falls back to bundled sample files when Blob Storage or Cosmos DB is unavailable."
}
```

/api/data-status confirms sample mode and explains fallback path.

Score request flow

Build path diagram for the Riyadh Mobility Intelligence starter kit



Score request flow

$$\text{score} = (\text{nearby metro count} \times 3) + \text{nearby bus count} - \text{live delay penalty}$$

Adaptation note: Keep this formula easy to explain. Teams can later replace the weights or add parking, walkability, public services, heat, or event density.

7. Frontend Walkthrough

The frontend is a single-page application built with Vanilla JavaScript. On startup it fetches config, routes, metro, bus, districts, events, and data status in parallel.

Layer	What it shows	Why it matters
Metro lines	high-capacity mobility corridors	shows structural transit coverage
Bus routes	surface transit coverage	shows fine-grained network reach
Districts	selectable district points	anchors the score conversation
Live events	delay or incident markers	demonstrates cloud-live extension potential
Accessibility buffer	rough selected-district service area	makes the score formula visible



District selector in the dashboard.

Score panel story

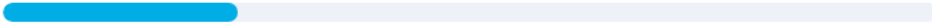
Selected district The panel names the district in focus.	Score and rating A readable number and label summarize access.	Route counts Metro and bus counts explain the score.
Delay penalty Live event data can reduce the score.	Formula The current calculation is visible and replaceable.	Data source badge The panel explains sample, Blob, or Cosmos mode.

TRANSIT SCORE

Total score: **14** **HIGH** of ~24 max



Nearby metro lines (×3 pts) **1**



Nearby bus routes (×1 pt) **11**



$$\text{score} = (1 \times 3) + 11 - 0 = 14$$

Hackathon-friendly proxy — not a formal transport model.
Designed to show how open data, cloud storage, and
simple scoring can support district-level planning
conversations.

District score panel after selecting a Riyadh district.

8. Cloud-Live Deployment

The cloud-live path is the deployable version of the same starter kit. Use it when a team needs to show that the app can move beyond a laptop and into a credible Azure environment.

Deployment workflow

Authenticate az login and azd auth login. identity	Initialize azd init and set target environment if needed. environment	Deploy Run bash scripts/deploy_azure.sh. provision
Verify Open WEB_APP_URL, /health, and /api/data-status. smoke tests	Operate Use App Insights and logs if the app fails or loads slowly. diagnostics	Teardown Run destroy_resource_group.sh --yes when finished. cleanup

```
az login
azd auth login
azd init
bash scripts/deploy_azure.sh
bash scripts/deploy_azure.sh eastus rg-riyadh-ud-eastus
```

Azure resource	Role
Azure Container Apps	hosts FastAPI and the static frontend
Azure Container Registry	stores the built container image
Azure Maps account	supports cloud map services
Azure Blob Storage	stores raw and processed mobility files
Azure Cosmos DB	stores route, district, and event records
Application Insights	tracks health, latency, failures, and requests
Log Analytics	stores logs and diagnostics

After deploy: Copy WEB_APP_URL from azd output, open the deployed app, check /health and /api/data-status, confirm active mode, and inspect App Insights if anything fails.

9. Starter Kit Adaptation Routes

Treat this codebase as a scaffold. Keep the working shell, replace the domain data, and adapt the score or map layers toward the track the team is pursuing.

Route	Best fit	Keep / add	Likely services
Mobility Command View	Transformational Technology	Keep route layers, event overlay, selector, KPIs, data-status. Add congestion, parking demand, peak simulation, delay explanations.	Azure Maps, Event Hubs, Stream Analytics, Cosmos DB, App Insights
District Intelligence	Prosperous People	Keep district selector, score panel, map focus, Cosmos-ready records. Add service access, walkability, comparison.	Azure Maps, Blob Storage, Cosmos DB, Container Apps, optional Azure OpenAI
Sustainable Mobility Overlay	Sustainable Solutions	Keep mobility layers and selected district context. Add AQI, heat, pollution, clean corridors, emissions scoring.	Azure Maps, Blob Storage, Cosmos DB, Power BI, App Insights
Culture and Visitor Movement	Culture	Keep map layers, event markers, route overlays, selected place panel. Add heritage sites, multilingual notes, event-day access.	Azure Maps, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Apps, optional translation

Winning pattern: Preserve the local-first API, map shell, fallback chain, and deployment path. Replace the domain data and scoring logic only after the core path is working.

10. Demo Flow

Step	Show	Explain
1	Dashboard landing view	This is a Riyadh mobility intelligence starter kit, not just a static map.
2	Metro and bus toggles	The map layers show public transport coverage.
3	District selector	District context drives the scoring workflow.
4	Score panel	The score is transparent and easy to adapt.
5	/api/data-status	The app is fallback-aware and cloud-live ready.
6	Azure workflow	Services map to hosting, maps, files, records, and monitoring.
7	Adaptation routes	The same scaffold supports multiple hackathon tracks.

Demo rule: Keep the live demo local unless the deployed app has already passed /health and /api/data-status checks.

Appendix

Common Commands

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env
python -m uvicorn app.main:app --reload
python -m pytest
python scripts/validate_data.py
bash scripts/deploy_azure.sh
bash scripts/destroy_resource_group.sh --yes
```

Debugging Checklist

- If the page loads slowly, wait for the district selector, layer controls, map area, and score panel before judging success.
- If the map is blank, clear `AZURE_MAPS_KEY` in `.env` and reload so the local fallback can be used.
- If cloud data is missing, open `/api/data-status` first.
- If sample files fail, run `python scripts/validate_data.py`.
- If the deployed app fails, check `/health`, `/api/data-status`, Container App logs, and Application Insights.

Resource Index

Need	Open
GitHub repo	https://github.com/Esturban/microsoft-hackathon-riyadh-mobility
Local dashboard	http://127.0.0.1:8000
atomcamp Arabia	https://atomcamparabia.com/
Azure Developer CLI docs	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/developer/azure-developer-cli/
Azure Maps docs	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/azure-maps/
Student quickstart	README.md
Architecture notes	docs/architecture.md
Azure deployment notes	docs/azure_deployment.md
Troubleshooting	docs/troubleshooting.md